ICT2142 E- Business Systems

Lecture 07

Digital Marketing for E-Business

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Digital Marketing for E-Business

Learning Objectives

- Explain the roles of SEO, SEM and social media marketing in attracting online customers.
- Distinguish affiliate marketing from influencer marketing and describe their revenue models.
- Explain how personalization improves relevance, engagement and conversion in e-business.
- Describe customer engagement strategies across the digital customer journey.
- Explain how CRM systems support acquisition, retention, service and long-term customer value.

Digital Marketing in an E-Business Context

- Digital marketing uses online channels, data and technology to attract, engage, convert and retain customers.
- E-business connects marketing activities with websites, e-commerce platforms, payment systems, analytics, customer service and CRM.
- Common channels include search engines, social platforms, email, content, affiliates, influencers and mobile applications.
- Performance can be measured using reach, traffic, engagement, leads, conversion rate, customer acquisition cost and customer lifetime value.

Key idea: *digital marketing is not only promotion; it is a measurable part of the complete digital customer journey.*

Search Engine Optimization (SEO)

- SEO improves the visibility of web pages in unpaid (organic) search results.
- **On-page SEO:** useful content, search intent, titles, headings, internal links, descriptive URLs and image information.
- **Technical SEO:** crawlability, indexing, mobile usability, page performance, HTTPS and structured site architecture.
- **Off-page SEO:** reputation and relevant links or mentions from other trustworthy websites.
- For e-business, SEO can bring potential customers to category pages, product pages, service pages and educational content.

Example: *an online electronics store optimizes a product-category page for users searching for "wireless headphones".*

SEO Process



SEO is continuous: understand user intent, publish useful content, make it technically accessible, then measure search performance and improve.

Search Engine Marketing (SEM)

- SEM commonly refers to paid search advertising that places sponsored results for selected search queries.
- Advertisers choose keywords/audiences, create ads and landing pages, set budgets and bid strategies, and measure results.
- Common measures include impressions, clicks, click-through rate (CTR), cost per click (CPC), conversions and return on ad spend (ROAS).
- A strong SEM campaign aligns the search query, advertisement, landing page and conversion goal.
- Paid search can create immediate visibility, while SEO normally builds organic visibility over time.

SEO vs. SEM



SEO

Organic visibility; content and technical optimization; longer-term asset.



SEM

Paid search visibility; budget and bidding; rapid campaign activation.



Shared Goal

Reach users with relevant search intent and move them toward useful actions.



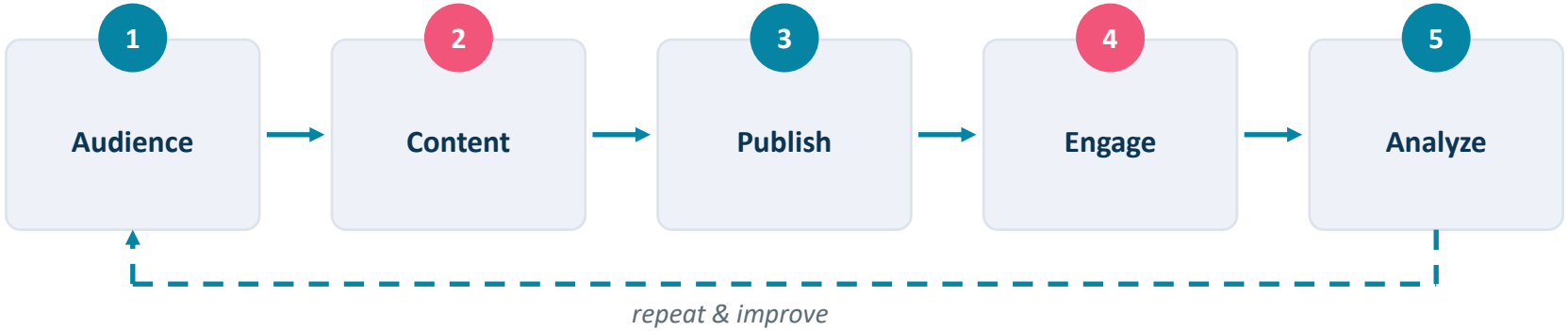
Use Together

SEM can test demand quickly while SEO develops sustainable organic discovery.

Social Media Marketing Fundamentals

- Uses social platforms to build awareness, community, website traffic, leads, sales and customer relationships.
- Organic activities include posts, short-form video, stories, communities, replies and user-generated content.
- Paid social uses targeting and advertising to reach defined audiences and support campaign objectives.
- Content should match the platform, audience, brand voice and stage of the customer journey.
- Measure reach, impressions, engagement rate, video views, link clicks, conversions and sentiment—not only follower count.

Social Media Marketing Cycle



Use analytics to learn what audiences respond to; feed those insights back into the next content and campaign cycle.

Affiliate Marketing

- Affiliate marketing is performance-based promotion in which a partner refers potential customers to a merchant.
- Unique links, codes or tracking identifiers attribute clicks, leads or sales to the affiliate.
- Common compensation models include cost per sale, cost per lead and other agreed performance actions.
- Key participants: merchant/advertiser, affiliate/publisher, customer and tracking/affiliate platform.
- Benefits include extended reach and performance-linked cost; risks include poor-quality, traffic, misleading promotion and attribution issues.

Example: *a technology review site links to an online store and receives an agreed commission for qualifying purchases.*

Affiliate Marketing Flow



Tracking connects the referral to the desired action so that performance can be measured and the affiliate can be rewarded.

Influencer Marketing

- Influencer marketing works with creators or trusted individuals who communicate with an established audience.
- Collaborations may include sponsored posts, demonstrations, reviews, tutorials, live content, launches or ambassador relationships.
- Influencer selection should consider audience relevance, content quality, credibility, engagement and brand fit—not follower count alone.
- Measure reach, engagement, referral traffic, tracked conversions, cost per acquisition and campaign-specific goals.
- Commercial relationships should be disclosed clearly and campaigns should follow applicable advertising and platform rules.

Affiliate vs. Influencer Marketing



Affiliate

Primarily performance-driven; tracked links/codes; commission commonly linked to actions.



Influencer

Primarily creator/audience relationship; may use fixed fees, products, commissions or combinations.



Overlap

An influencer can also act as an affiliate when referrals are tracked and rewarded.



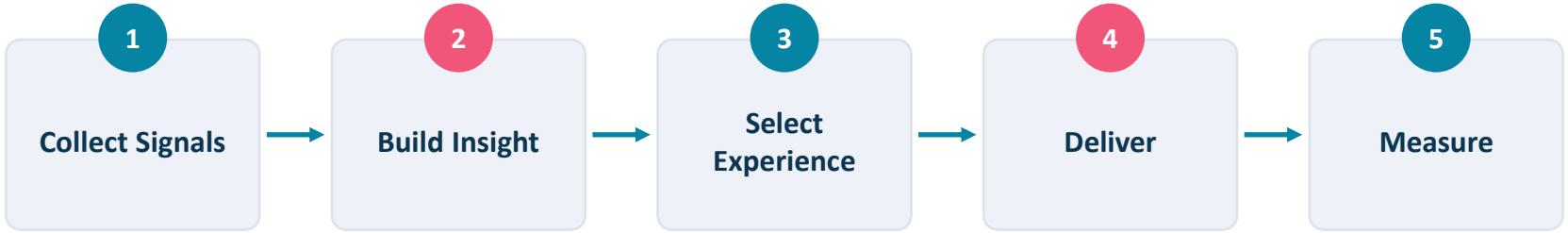
Management

Define objectives, audience, message, tracking, disclosure requirements and performance metrics.

Personalization in E-Business

- Personalization adapts digital experiences using relevant customer, contextual and behavioral information.
- Examples include product recommendations, personalized homepages, targeted email, remembered preferences and relevant offers.
- Useful signals may include browsing behavior, purchase history, search activity, location at an appropriate level, device/context and declared preferences.
- Rule-based personalization uses predefined conditions; data-driven approaches can identify patterns and recommend relevant content or products.
- Personalization should be transparent, privacy-aware and designed to provide genuine customer value.

Personalization Process



Example: browsing and purchase signals → customer/product insight → relevant recommendation → website/email delivery → conversion and engagement measurement.

Customer Engagement Strategies

- Customer engagement is the ongoing interaction between a business and customers across digital touchpoints.
- Useful strategies include valuable content, responsive support, email lifecycle messages, loyalty programs, communities, reviews and feedback.
- Omnichannel engagement aims for consistent experiences across website, app, email, social media and service channels.
- Automation can support welcome messages, abandoned-cart reminders, post-purchase communication and service notifications.
- Engagement quality can be evaluated using repeat visits, retention, response rate, repeat purchase, satisfaction and customer lifetime value.

CRM in E-Business

- Customer Relationship Management (CRM) combines business processes, customer data and technology to manage customer relationships.
- A CRM can maintain customer profiles, contact history, leads/opportunities, purchases, service interactions, preferences and campaign responses.
- Operational CRM supports sales, marketing and service activities; analytical CRM uses customer data to generate insights for decisions.
- In e-business, CRM can connect marketing, e-commerce and customer-service touchpoints to create a more consistent customer view.
- CRM supports acquisition, conversion, retention, service quality and long-term relationship development.

CRM Data Flow



Website, e-commerce, email and support interactions can feed a CRM; the resulting customer view supports relevant communication and better service.

CRM and the Customer Lifecycle



Acquire

Capture leads and campaign sources; understand which channels attract customers.



Convert

Track interactions and opportunities; support relevant follow-up and offers.



Serve

Record issues and communication so service teams have customer context.



Retain & Grow

Use history and preferences for loyalty, re-engagement, cross-sell and relationship development.

Responsible Use of Customer Data

- Collect only data that has a legitimate business purpose and handle it according to applicable privacy requirements.
- Communicate clearly what data is collected and how it is used; provide appropriate customer choices and preference controls.
- Protect customer information through access controls, authentication, encryption, secure integrations and appropriate retention practices.
- Avoid intrusive or discriminatory personalization; regularly review automated segmentation and targeting decisions.
- Trust is a business asset: misuse of customer data can damage relationships even when a campaign appears technically effective.

Integrated Digital Marketing Example

- An e-business publishes an optimized product guide so potential customers can discover it through organic search (SEO).
- A paid search campaign targets high-intent queries and directs visitors to a relevant landing page (SEM).
- Social content and creators demonstrate the product; selected partners use tracked referrals (social, influencer and affiliate marketing).
- Website behavior and customer preferences support relevant recommendations and follow-up communication (personalization).
- CRM records customer interactions and supports service, retention and future campaigns; analytics measures performance across the journey.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)



Awareness

Reach, impressions, share of visibility and video views.



Acquisition

Organic traffic, paid clicks, CTR, CPC and cost per acquisition.



Engagement

Interaction rate, time/quality of visit, email engagement and response rate.



Conversion

Leads, purchases, conversion rate, average order value and revenue/ROAS.



Retention

Repeat purchase, churn/retention, customer satisfaction and customer lifetime value.

Choose KPIs that match the business objective; a large number of clicks is not valuable if the desired customer outcome does not occur.

Summary

- SEO develops organic search visibility; SEM uses paid search to reach users with relevant intent.
- Social media supports awareness, community, traffic and conversion through organic and paid activities.
- Affiliate marketing rewards tracked performance, while influencer marketing leverages creator-audience relationships; the two can overlap.
- Personalization uses relevant data to tailor customer experiences and should be privacy-aware.
- CRM connects customer information and processes across marketing, sales and service to support long-term relationships.

Thank you… !